VOL. I WEEKDAY EDITION

THE ELON GAZETTE

Weekday briefing on what Elon Musk is saying and doing

TUESDAY, OCTOBER 27, 2026

THE MORNING PICTURE

Six million miles, and "2 or 3 years"

Tesla's updated safety page now puts cars driven with FSD (Supervised) at 6,006,200 miles per major collision in North America over the latest 12 months, against 2,031,221 miles for Teslas driven manually with active safety features and a U.S. average of 660,164. Tesla counts a collision against FSD if the system was active within five seconds of impact. At 11:55 p.m. EDT on Monday, Elon Musk replied with a "100" emoji to a post by Pierre Ferragu that it is "10x safer to not-drive FSD than to drive a non-Tesla. What are you waiting for, Europe?" Earlier in the day Musk had welcomed approval of the software in Latvia.

On the SpaceX side, Verizon's chief executive told analysts on Monday that a Starlink Mobile network able to compete in U.S. cities would take years and hundreds of billions of dollars, Yahoo Finance reported. Musk's reply at 1:40 p.m. EDT: "Will take 2 or 3 years." The same day, Starlink's phone service went live across Brazil.

I · TESLA & AUTONOMY

"Bravo to the smaller countries"

FSD (Supervised) won approval in Latvia, Tesla posted new safety figures, and Musk said Austin's robotaxi race "was never a real contest."

Latvia	6,006,200	+5.21%
latest European country to approve FSD (Supervised)	miles per major collision with FSD (Supervised), latest 12 months	TSLA on Monday, to $391.62, after a Barclays upgrade

"Now approved in Latvia. Rollout begins soon," Tesla Europe posted at 6:36 a.m. EDT on Monday. Musk quote-posted it at 1:33 p.m. with "Supervised FSD approved in Latvia!" (post). Sawyer Merritt counted Latvia as the 10th European country to approve the software, which is called Tesla Assisted Driving in Europe. Quoting that list at 1:38 p.m., Musk wrote: "Bravo to the smaller countries in Europe for moving fastest!"

The safety figures that Musk endorsed late Monday cover about 9.48 billion FSD miles and 1,579 major collisions, Tesla Mag reported; China is not included. Tesla does not assign fault and updates the figures quarterly. The company's safety claims for the software "are highly contested by safety researchers," Reuters noted on Tuesday.

QUICK HIT

FSD on Turo. Starting October 28, U.S. guests on Turo can search for and book Teslas with FSD (Supervised) activated, with the status checked through Tesla's API, the car-sharing company said in a release. Eligible hosts get a free one-month trial.

Barclays upgrades Tesla

Tesla shares closed Monday at $391.62, up 5.21%, after Barclays analyst Dan Levy upgraded the stock, forecasting 1.80 million deliveries this year and 1.92 million in 2027 after two straight annual declines, Yahoo Finance reported. The note also pointed to "the potential premium from a combination with SPCX," and Barclays sees an all-stock purchase of Tesla by SpaceX as the most likely structure.



Building 1 at Tesla's Gigafactory Texas near Austin, shown on June 17, 2022.
PHOTO: LARRY D. MOORE / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC BY 4.0 (CROPPED)

Cabs in Austin

"We don't run every day because the line can run so fast, it's currently outpacing our deployments," Tesla vice president of vehicle engineering Lars Moravy said of the Cybercab line in a Munro Live tour published Monday, TeslaNorth reported. Tesla sent more than 50 Cybercabs to the Austin Formula 1 weekend, according to TeslaNorth's account of the tour.

Replying at 12:03 a.m. EDT on Tuesday to a post saying the battle for autonomous rides in Austin might already be over, Musk wrote: "It was never a real contest" (post). At 12:24 a.m. he quote-posted a Cybercab video with the words "A Storm of Cybercabs" (post). In Houston, the Robotaxi zone that grew on Monday now covers 254 square miles, Merritt posted, second only to Austin's 272.

ON THE WIRE

Latvia's rollout. Tesla Europe said the rollout of FSD (Supervised) in Latvia "begins soon" (post).

II · SPACEX & STARLINK

Phones in Brazil, a price tag from Verizon

Starlink Mobile went nationwide in Brazil with Vivo. Verizon's chief said a U.S. network would take years; Musk said two or three.

7M	$300B–$500B	230 t-F
phones already connected in Brazil, per Starlink	Verizon CEO's estimate of a U.S. buildout	what Raptor 3 can reliably reach, Musk says

"Starlink Mobile is now live in Brazil with @vivobr! 50M customers can use apps and messaging in cellular dead zones — with 7M phones already connected. This is the first nationwide service to cover the entire country," Starlink posted at 11:53 a.m. EDT Monday. Vivo calls the service Vivo Satélite. Customers on eligible plans can use messaging apps and maps where there is no tower signal, and video calls and general web browsing stay blocked, O Globo reported.



A train of Starlink satellites crosses the night sky over the town hall in Tübingen, Germany, on April 24, 2020.

PHOTO: DKTUE / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC0 (CROPPED)

Verizon on Starlink Mobile

In the United States, Verizon chief executive Daniel Schulman told analysts on the company's third-quarter call: "There is no magic wand. There's no secret sauce. There's no shortcut." "Their service just can't compete with a terrestrial network. In suburban and urban areas, where 98% of our revenues are," he said. "We're somewhere between 100 to 1000 times more efficient than they are." He estimated an all-in cost of $300 billion to $500 billion over the next six to seven years, assuming a buildout of at least four to six years, Yahoo Finance reported. Musk replied to Merritt's summary of the remarks: "Will take 2 or 3 years." He did not address the cost. SpaceX is in talks for access to at least 80,000 U.S. cell sites, Bloomberg reported.

Starlink on airlines

At 1:36 p.m. EDT Musk quote-posted a post marking "50 airlines and counting" for Starlink with a pitch of his own: "Try using @Starlink for your home or business" (post).

Raptor and Starship

Hours after saying Raptor 4 would make 300 tons of thrust at sea level, Musk qualified the current engine. Replying at 1:13 p.m. EDT to a post that put Raptor 4 at 7.1% more powerful than Raptor 3, he wrote: "We can only reliably get to around 230 t-F with Raptor 3." At Starbase, Texas, Ship 42, the ship for Flight 15, ran a single-engine static fire on Monday night, NASASpaceflight posted at 10:18 p.m. EDT. Falcon 9 then launched 27 Starlink satellites from Vandenberg Space Force Base at 3:25 a.m. EDT on Tuesday, Spaceflight Now reported, and SpaceX confirmed deployment at 4:29 a.m.

> QUICK HIT
>
> **"Soon Moon."** At 12:31 p.m. EDT Musk quote-posted a full-moon image that astrophotographer Andrew McCarthy built from about 50,000 telescope photos. When McCarthy replied that he hoped to get "a cheap lift to the moon one day," Musk wrote: "It will happen."

ON THE WIRE

Brazil by the numbers. Starlink says 50M Vivo customers can use apps and messaging in cellular dead zones, with 7M phones already connected (post).

"Probability of 20GW is currently rising"

Musk recast his compute forecast, said robots will need more memory than everything else on Earth, and proposed a harder robot test.

Replying to Peter Diamandis, who had written that Musk "says he could bring 20 gigawatts of compute online next year," Musk posted at 12:27 p.m. EDT Monday: "I said 20GWs next year is extremely unlikely, just not 0%, whereas the probability was 0% even a few months ago. Probability of 20GW is currently rising with time."

Michael Dell on Musk as a customer

A clip shared by firesidealpha has Michael Dell calling Musk the "most demanding customer there is"; the account says Musk rewarded Dell with more business after the Colossus build. Musk replied at 12:18 p.m.: "True."

Musk on robot memory demand

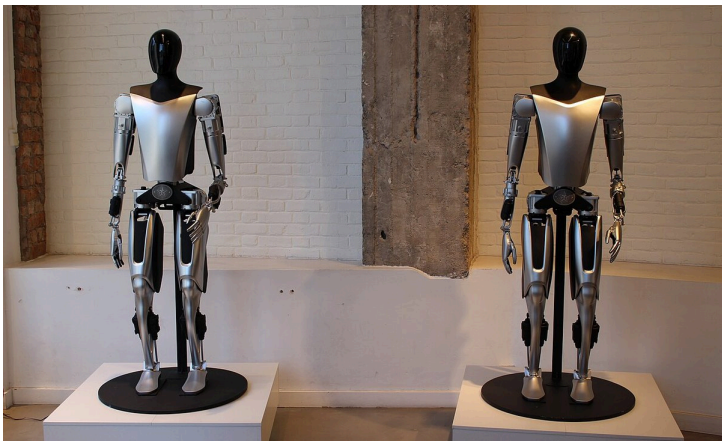
At 1:32 p.m. he took on an estimate that humanoid robots would use only a sliver of the world's memory chips. "Robot RAM needs will exceed everything else on Earth, as you need the robots to be on physical substates in order to shape atoms," he wrote. "Super intelligence needs will vastly exceed that, but ~100% of SI will be deep space compute. Obviously."

Musk on Cohere's sandbox report

He reacted with a raised-eyebrow emoji at 1:14 p.m. (post) to a report from the AI company Cohere that, while it tested the Qwen3.8-Flash-Next model in a controlled sandbox, the model was asked to generate a defensive cybersecurity detection rule and "instead inventoried aspects of the machine it was running on."

Musk answers Nvidia's Jensen Huang

At 12:56 a.m. EDT Tuesday he answered "Cute" to Nvidia chief executive Jensen Huang's wrap-up of the company's GTC conference in Berlin, which opened: "I was the opening act for a family of ducks." Huang's post also promoted Vera Rubin "modular factories built, cabled and tested in the factory."



Two Tesla Optimus humanoid robots on display in Stockholm on May 13, 2024.
PHOTO: ULF KLINGSTRÖM / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · PUBLIC DOMAIN

Carmack's robot benchmark

Late Monday, John Carmack wrote that "there is no robot in the world that can change the batteries in a jack-o-lantern," listing steps such as opening a package of AA batteries and unscrewing tiny screws. "These are real benchmarks," Musk replied at 12:59 a.m. EDT Tuesday.

> QUICK HIT
> **A harder test.** Minutes later Musk added his own: "How about the robot is looking down while assembling a Swiss watch with one hand and then, without looking up, catches an oblique 100mph baseball with the other hand?"

"Over 100 features & fixes" a week

Musk asked users what Grok Bot should do better and said more messaging platforms are coming.

"What are most important things to improve about Grok @Bot? Btw, make sure you've tried Bot recently, as over 100 features & fixes are released every week!" Musk posted at 12:11 p.m. EDT Monday. Five minutes later, when a user asked to let other people message his bots directly, he wrote: "Bot can communicate via email and X DMs. Other messaging platforms coming soon." To a user whose X app crashed when opening Grok Bot in direct messages, he asked at 12:30 p.m. whether the problem was still there after updating the app.

At 1:35 p.m. he quote-posted a user who said Grok Bot checks email, DMs, mentions and LinkedIn every hour, flags anything interesting and drafts replies: "Grok @Bot is like hiring an incredibly competent chief of staff" (post).

Takeaways

1. **Latvia approved FSD (Supervised), and Musk endorsed new safety figures of 6,006,200 miles per major collision.**
2. **Tesla rose 5.21% after a Barclays upgrade; Turo begins FSD rentals on October 28.**
3. **Starlink Mobile went live nationwide in Brazil with Vivo.**
4. **Verizon's CEO put a U.S. Starlink Mobile buildout at years; Musk said "2 or 3."**
5. **Musk said the odds of 20 gigawatts of compute next year are rising.**

Sources

Posts by @elonmusk, @teslaeurope, @SawyerMerritt, @p_ferragu, @Starlink, @SpaceX, @NASASpaceflight, @SpaceflightNow, @cb_doge, @niccruzpatane, @AJamesMcCarthy, @PeterDiamandis, @firesidealpha, @cohere, @JensenHuang, @zephyr_z9, @ID_AA_Carmack, @Jason_A_Scharf, @thesimple_sarah, @nima_owji, @AustinTByrd, @TRHLofficial and @profstonge.

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